in March, former party president Rahul Gandhi had insisted on making pragmatic promises. "We have a bright future in Gujarat. Don't promise people the moon if you can't get them the moon," he advised. He also asked them to put their heart into the fight against the BJP. "You can't win if you are mentally defeated," he is reported to have said.

Acting on his advice, the Congress is focusing on the tribal areas, which it believes could be a game-changer this time. Anant Patel, its MLA from Vansda, mobilised tribals against the Centre's project to link the Par, Tapi and Narmada rivers. Union finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman had announced the Par-Tapi-Narmada linking project in her budget speech in February. The project was to transfer river water from the surplus regions of the Western Ghats to the deficit regions of Saurashtra and Kutch. The Par originates from Nashik in Maharashtra and flows through Valsad, Gujarat; the Tapi originates in the Satpura range and runs through Maharashtra and Surat; the Narmada originates in MP and flows through Maharashtra and Gujarat's Bharuch and Narmada districts.

Tapping into the tribals' fears that the river-linking project will displace them, Anant Patel led protests in several places in east Gujarat. On April 5, state BJP president Patil announced that the Centre has decided to stall the project in the absence of consent from the governments of Gujarat and Maharashtra. This has come as a shot in the arm for the Congress.

Strong support from its core voters—Muslims and tribals—has been the Congress's strength, and the party has been alleging that the BJP has invited the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) to Gujarat to cut into that base. According to political observer Shirish Kashikar, Asaduddin Owaisi's AIMIM (All-India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen) is another headache for the Congress as it has been weaning away its traditional Muslim votes.

A bigger problem, however, is

#BeTheBetterGuy
A Road Safety Initiative

HYUNDAI Moving the world Together
A CSR initiative by Hyundai Motor India Foundation
× INDIA TODAY GROUP

TAKE A PLEDGE TO DRIVE SAFELY



The theme for this year's road safety is best summarized as Sadak Suraksha Jeevan Raksha. It's a part of the Be The Better Guy road safety initiative brought to you by India Today Group and Hyundai Motor India Foundation.

Talking about the inspiration behind the campaign, Puneet Anand - Assistant Vice President & Group Head - Corporate Affairs & Corporate Communication, Hyundai Motor India Ltd. said "This campaign is hugely influenced by our global vision, which is called Progress for Humanity. Hyundai aims to inculcate a habit of safe driving in the people of India to make them better citizens and at the same time make Indian roads safer road to drive on."

Over the years, cars have become really safe. Companies like Hyundai are leading the way. They launched the i20 many years back with six airbags. It was the first car in its segment to have that many airbags. The steel that's being used in the cars is also of a much superior quality and has a high tensile strength. There are a lot of active and passive safety features that are being built in cars. More and more driver assistance systems are coming into cars that help the driver make the right decisions.

So, cars are being made much safer overall than before, but people also have to change. That's where Be The Better Guy campaign fits in so well. The change has to come from within, the change has to come from the people behind the wheel.

Hyundai's Puneet Anand gives a very important message to the youth of this country, "We as a responsible manufacturer can give you all safety gadgets, but you have to care for yourself, you have to care for the pedestrians, you have to care for the country, and you have to care to be a better citizen on the road."



PUNEET ANAND
Assistant Vice President &
Group Head - Corporate Affairs &
Corporate Communication
Hyundai Motor India Ltd.

This campaign is hugely influenced by our global vision, which is called Progress for Humanity. Hyundai aims to inculcate a habit of safe driving in the people of India to make them better citizens and at the same time make Indian roads safer road to drive on.